D H A R

Volume IV — Program Management

THE PACT OF DEVELOPING DHAR

“A pact with the project's own future work: what counts as done, and who owes what.”

Document	The Pact of Developing Dhar
Version	1.0
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Status	Ratified
Part of	The Canon of Dhar, Volume IV (the whole of Volume IV)
Depends on	Every prior volume — this document synthesizes, it does not originate
Audience	Leadership, contributors

1. Mandate

Collect the roadmap, the risks, and the success metrics that the rest of this Canon already produced piece by piece, into one place accountable for tracking them as a whole. Every item below is a cross-reference to a claim ratified elsewhere, not a new claim invented here — The Pact's job is synthesis and follow-through, not authorship.

2. Roadmap, in Dependency Order

Stated as a dependency sequence, not a calendar — this Canon does not fabricate target dates it has no basis to commit to; each stage's own document (Volume II) states exactly what must be true before the next one may begin.

Order	Milestone	Gate to the next milestone
1	Stage-alpha compiles the bootstrap subset	Stage-alpha compiles Stage-beta's complete source (Stage-alpha §4)
2	Stage-beta is self-hosting	Byte-for-byte identical generation-2 rebuild (Stage-beta §4) — the one criterion that matters
3	Stage-gamma reaches a minimum viable optimizer	SSA + register allocation + dead-code elimination landed (Stage-gamma §5)
4	Stage-delta: Kun and the standard library work	Every acceptance criterion in Stage-delta §7, including a demonstrated interop example per language in §4
5	Stage-epsilon: production-ready	Reproducible, signed, cross-compiled, SBOM'd releases (Stage-epsilon §4)

Volume III's six documents do not gate Volume II's engineering sequence and were written in parallel deliberately — trust, adoption, and sustainability work starting late is a slower failure than starting before Stage-alpha exists, not a safer one.

3. Risk Register

Risk	Where it's named	Mitigation of record
A Thompson-style compiler backdoor surviving self-hosting undetected	Tempering Dhar §5.3	Diverse Double-Compiling, flagged as a required Stage-epsilon criterion once a second independent implementation exists
Single-maintainer bus factor	The Guild of Dhar §6, Fueling Dhar §4	Foundation-transition trigger tied to funding or a multi-employer contributor base, not a calendar date
Funding runs out before Stage-epsilon	Fueling Dhar §3	Sovereign Tech Fund and comparable infrastructure-focused funders, applied for against scoped deliverables, not general support
Spec1 scope creep undermining Spec0's simplicity commitment	Observed directly in this Canon's own history: 37 keywords (Spec1 v1.0) grew to 46 (v3.0) inside one revision cycle	Every future Spec1 addition must go through The Guild of Dhar §3's RFC process, including the explicit alternative-considered-and-rejected discipline, rather than being added ad hoc
Adoption strategy depends on institutions Dhar does not control	Casting Dhar §3–4 (3MTT, Smart Africa)	Curriculum content designed as a portable module (Casting Dhar §2.1), not wired irreversibly into one program's specifics
Hardware/connectivity constraints silently excluding the primary target users	Casting Dhar §3.2	Kun's offline-cache requirement (Stage-delta §3.3, added specifically for this) tracked as a release-blocking property, not an optimization
Premature or overstated certification claims damaging credibility	Tempering Dhar §7	This Canon's own discipline of stating readiness rather than possession, audited by whether future documents keep to it
Export-control exposure from std.crypto or a defence-specific build	The Hallmark of Dhar §5	Mandatory legal review triggered at std.crypto's first releasable state, not deferred indefinitely

4. Success Metrics

Engineering metrics (this Canon's own Volume II acceptance criteria are the primary record) plus the adoption metrics Casting Dhar §6 proposed, formalized here as the set this Canon actually tracks going forward:

- Stage completion against Volume II's acceptance criteria — binary, per stage, not a percentage estimate.
- 3MTT fellows completing the Dhar module, and how many publish a Kun package afterward (Casting Dhar §6).
- Non-trivial published Kun packages and their sustained (not launch-week) download counts.
- Countries with an active local user group, against Smart Africa's member-state list as the honest ceiling.
- Government or institutional pilot deployments — the metric this Canon weights most heavily, since it is the one that validates Spec0 §5 rather than merely gesturing at it.
- Funding secured against scoped deliverables (Fueling Dhar §3), tracked separately from general goodwill or interest.

5. How This Document Stays Honest

The Pact is reviewed whenever a Volume II stage completes or a Volume III document is amended, specifically to catch exactly the failure mode §3's fourth risk names: a Canon that keeps growing in one place without anyone checking whether an earlier promise quietly stopped being true. A risk in §3 that has been mitigated is marked closed with the evidence, not deleted; a new risk discovered during any stage's work is added here rather than left implicit in that stage's own document.

The Pact of Developing Dhar · v1.0 · September 9, 2026 · Ratified. This document completes the initial ratification of all four Volumes of the Canon of Dhar. Revision log: v1.0 — first ratified edition, synthesizing roadmap, risk, and metrics content from Spec0, Spec1, all five Volume II stage documents, and all six Volume III documents.